Kliknij tu, by przeglądać tę stronę po polsku. Click here to browse this website in Polish.

The proposed changes in contemporary Polish spelling

1. Foreword

I would like to present my proposal of changes in the spelling of Polish language. I encountered problems related to displaying Polish letters: when the source code of a website does not indicate a code page, an Internet browser replaces these letters with incorrect characters or removes them from the text. I admire my national tongue with all my heart, so I was thoroughly looking for a solution to such difficulties so that it would be in harmony with the past and future times. Exploring works of Grzegorz Jagodziński, prof. Bronisław Rocławski and Marcin Kowalczyk, I came to my own conclusion that ensuring the writing system's compliance with digital communication standards will bring the most benefits.

Let us strive for changes with consciousness and strive collectively. The voice of a people influences response of the world, so all nations can adapt to ours. Nowadays intellectual progress is dependent on profit like never before. Let us work in this field of our own language, and the rest will accept it. In this way, we will also make it easier for the world to learn about our culture.

Benefits of the change

1. Greater [see *3. Tables, 5. Example*]
    - Distinction of consonant clusters *rz, dz* from consonants written with the same letters.
    - Facilitation for people with dyslexia by reduction of acutes and dots marking different letters.
    - Less loss of pronunciation and meaning data of words in the case of deliberate omission of modifiers *q, v, x*, as also diacritics are omitted in typing.
2. Lesser
    - Easier connecting letters if the use of dots and acutes above letters shall be completely abandoned.
    - Hence, a higher probability to write in the dark while staying the row lines.
    - Connection with the Polish language's history, if only because of keeping distinct letter pairs: *rz, ż as rq, zq*.
    - The spelling rules' name (referred to as QVX), according to the Classical Latin script, shall be pronounced short as */kuks/, /cooks/, /kuchs/, /cux/* in Polish, English, German or Spanish language respectively.

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2. Evidence

Typewriters are already out of use as stand-alone devices, while more and more types of electronic equipment are communicating with the user using a displayed text. Every day, approximately 36% world's population uses the Latin alphabet and its variations (according to *WorldStandards.eu*), but not every device is adapted to support text in Polish. The commonly used SMS system allows sending up to 160 characters covered by the seven-bit GSM standard. This number is reduced to 140 characters for a 8-bit coded message, i.e. it contains at least one letter within Polish alphabet. These changes in the spelling of the Polish language, which I propose to introduce by official means, admittedly increase the volume of the text, but limit the set of letters to twenty-six characters of the Latin alphabet without diacritized letters.

The ways of entering letters within Polish alphabet are varied among machines: the telephone keypad requires repeated pressing of a key to which three to four letters of the Latin alphabet have been assigned alternately with the letters of the Polish alphabet (for example, *Nokia 2700 classic* telephone) or omitting these Latin letters to enter one letter Polish (*Samsung GT-E1200*).

Typing these letters on the on-screen keyboard of devices with a many times larger display (diagonal of the display used in *Samsung SM-T235* tablet is 3.5 times larger than that of *Nokia 2700 classic* usually involves touching and holding a letter of the Latin alphabet, and then moving finger towards the corresponding diacritized letter. The first method was partly automated using the *T9 dictionary*, which constructs a word consisting of letters assigned to the keys pressed in turn only once. If the machine displays an undesirable word, use the * key to select another one, but consisting of letters placed under the same keys (*Nokia 2700 classic*). The combined or separate spelling of words depends only on the device's user – space is created by pressing *0*. An improved dictionary is found in devices with a touch screen: after entering the text, above the keyboard appears a list of words formed from the word on which the cursor is placed, and other words with similar spelling (*Samsung SM-T235*) are displayed. Completing or correcting a word is done by selecting one from the list or touching the space bar, depending on the machine setting.

3. Tables

Slavic A.	Contemporary A.	Altered spelling	
a	mama	mama	-a-a
	czytać	cqytacx	----a--
e	Ewa	Ewa	E--
	przyjaciel	prqyjacxel	--------e-
i	liczba	licqba	-i----
	zima	zxima	--i--
o	rok	rok	-o-
	most	most	-o--
u	mucha	muhha	-u---
	król	kroql	--oq-

y	być	bycx	-y--
	życie	zqycxe	--y---
ę	męski	mevzki	-ev---
	tęsknota	tevsknota	-ev------
ǫ	wąski	wovzki	-ov---
	książka	ksxovzqka	---ov----
i̯	moje	moje	--j-
	czerwiec	cqerwiec	-----i--
u̯	auto	auvto	-uv--
	miłość	milvosxcx	--lv-----
l	lala	lala	l-l-
	mleko	mleko	-l---

r	rura	rura	r-r-
	ród	roqd	r---
m	mama	mama	m-m-
	mur	mur	m--
ḿ	mieszek	mxesqek	mx-----
	miesiąc	mxesxovc	mx------
n	noga	noga	n---
	nadzieja	nadxeja	n------
ń	koń	konx	--nx
	trącić	trovcxicx	--ov-x---
ŋ	pękać	pevkacx	---k---
	tango	tango	--ng-

p	paczka	pacqka	p-----
	państwo	panxstwo	p-------
b	bajka	bajka	b----
	baza	baza	b---
f	fajka	fajka	f----
	pocztówka	pocqtoqwka	-------w--
v	woda	woda	w---
ṕ	piesek	pxesek	px----
	pić	picx	pi--
ḿ	biały	bxalvy	bx----
	ibis	ibis	-bi-
ḟ	trafia	trafxa	---fx-
	delfin	delfin	---fi-

ẃ	wiedzieć słownik	wxedxecx slvownxik	wx------ ----w-x--
t	tata miasto	tata mxasto	t-t- ----t-
d	rudy woda	rudy woda	--d- --d-
c	ulica dziecko	ulica dxecko	---c- ---c--
ʒ	dzwon rodzajnik	dvwon rodvajnxik	dv--- --dv------
s	ser słowo	ser slvowo	s-- s-----
z	zupa	zupa	z---

č	czarny	cqarny	cq----
	czekolada	cqekolada	cq-------
ǯ	dżem	dqem	dq--
	liczba	licqba	--cq--
š	szkoła	sqkolva	sq-----
	szafa	sqafa	sq---
ž	życie	zqycxe	zq----
	marzec	marqec	--rq--
ć	ciastko	cxastko	cx-----
	teściowa	tesxcxowa	----cx---
ʒ́	dziwny	dxiwny	dx----
	niedziela	nxedxela	---dx---

ś	siny	sxiny	sx---
	teść	tesxcx	--sx--
ź	ziarno	zxarno	zx----
	źrebak	zxrebak	zx-----
ḱ	kiedy	kxedy	kx---
	kitel	kitel	k----
ǵ	giąć	gxovcx	gx----
	gips	gips	g---
χ́	hiena	hiena	h----
	psychiatra	psyhhxatra	---hhx----
γ́	higiena	higxena	--gx---
	kuchćże	kuhhcxzqe	--hh-x---

k	kot szkoła	kot sqkolva	k-- --k----
g	gazeta grudzień	gazeta grudxenx	g----- g-------
χ	hak ucho	hak uhho	h-- -hh-
γ	klechda	klehhda	---hh--
ä	jajko przyjaciel	jajko prqyjacxel	-a--- -----a----
ė	dzień jeść	dxenx jesxcx	--e-- -e----
ȯ	ciocia	cxocxa	--o---

ü	Józio	Joqzxo	-oq---
	judzić	judxicx	-u-----
u̯	umysł	umyslv	u-----
	jabłko	jablvko	---lv--
l̥	myśl	mysxl	----l
	myślmy	mysxlmy	----l--
l′	lista	lista	l----
	lipiec	lipxec	l-----
r̥	wiatr	wxatr	----r
	rtęć	rtevcx	r-----
r′	balerina	balerina	----r---
	październik	pazdxernxik	------r-x--

ṃ	pism	pism	---m
	rytm	rytm	---m
ḿ	misiek	misxek	m-----
	miesiąc	mxesxovc	mx------
ṇ	piosnka	pxosnka	----n--
	blizn	blizn	----n
ṇ	sączek	sovcqek	-ov----
	mączka	movcqka	-ov----
ṅ	pieśń	pxesnx	----nx
	powaśńmy	powasxnxmy	------nx--
i̯	pański	panxski	--nx---
	gregoriański	gregorianxski	--------nx---

ńj	węgiel	wevgxel	-evgx--
	banki	banki	--nk-
ų̭	wąski	wovzki	-ov---
	trans	trans	---n-
ṕ	pić	picx	p---
ḿ	bić	bicx	b---
ṭ	trzy	trqy	t---
	strzelec	strqelec	-t------
ḍ	drzewo	drqewo	d-----
t′	tik	tik	t--
	bastion	bastjon	---t---

d′	diuk skądinąd	djuk skovdinovd	d--- ----d-----
c′	cito racja	cito racja	c--- --c--
ʒ′	Godzilla jedz inaczej	Godvilla jedv inacqej	--dv---- --dv -------
s′	sinus pasja	sinus pasja	s---- --s--
z′	zin wizja	zin wizja	z-- --z--
č′	czip sporadycznie	cqip sporadycqnxe	cq-- -------cq-x-
ǯ′	dżinsy	dqinsy	dq----

	dżin	dqin	dq--
š′	szin Sziwa	sqin Sqiwa	sq-- Sq---
ž′	reżim Żinzifowo	rezqim Zqinzifowo	--zq-- Zq--------

An underlined letter means that phonetic value of the next voice has changed, but this is written as the same character. The underline is not a part of spelling, but I introduced it here, maintaining that the letters *q, v, x* will not receive a phonetic value. I wrote more about it in the next chapter.

Contemporary A.	Altered spelling
nadzór	nadzoqr
Morze Śródziemne	Morqe Sxroqdzxemne

odżywiać	odzqywxacx
dżdżownica	dzqdqownxica
budżet	budzqet
marznąć	marznovcx
mierzić	mxerzxicx
móc – mogę	moqc – mogev
piekę – piec	pxekev – pxec
mąż – męski – męstwo	movzq – mevzki – mevztwo
wiązać – wąski	wxovzacx – wovzki
bliżej – bliski	blizqej – blizki
mnogi – mnóstwo	mnogi – mnoqstwo

zwyciężyć – zwycięstwo	zwycxevzqycx – zwycxevztwo
niebiosa – niebieski	nxebxosa – nxebxeski
płaszczyć – płaski	plvasqcqycx – plvaski
pański – pańszczyzna	panxski – panxsqcqyzna
lekarz – lekarski	lekarq – lekarski
lżyć – lekki	lzqycx – legki
Ślęża – Śląsk	Sxlevzqa – Sxlovzk

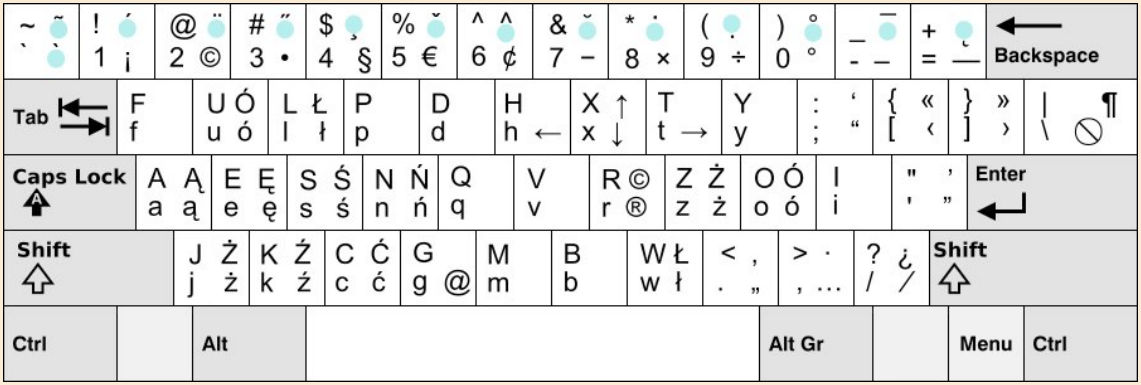
4. Cause

Based on the above tables, it can be concluded that the spelling reflects the pronunciation of words to an equal or greater extent than it was previously. The letter *i* is sufficient to indicate the palatalization of the previous one only if there is a consonant after it. Unification of the value of letter *i* after the consonant is a secondary part of the spelling changes, which by no means will bring benefits such as their original part. The pronunciation of sounds as voiced or voiceless deliberately still does not result directly from spelling, because it facilitates the inflection of words. Next, inflected words will always be written according to their etymology; the spelling of non-inflected words results from the pronunciation of related words and even their equivalents in other languages belonging to one family.

Each of the letters *q, v, x* modifies only one previous sound: *q* pulls back the place

of articulation, *v* forms a relation to a semi-vowel (dv is an exception), and *x* softens the consonant. None of these three letters has had or would receive a new phonetic value in native words or loanwords with spelling adapted to pronunciation, because they were not present in any of these. Such use of these letters or the elimination of diacritical signs from spelling should not be blocked due to aesthetic considerations or an attachment to current word shapes. However, these three modifying letters do not replace diacritical marks found in quotes in a foreign language; hardware-based inability to enter a diacritized letter prompts one to use a letter without such a character. This also applies to inclined vowels used in Polish dialects and in old literature.

Any Latin computer keyboard layout, just like the *QWERTY* commonly used in Polish country, will still be enough to write Polish. Nevertheless, this layout is not ergonomic and it is recommended to eliminate it. Below is an arrangement presented on *Klawa.pl* website, but modified for new use of the letters *q, v, x*. The assumptions accompanying the development of a character arrangement different from *QWERTY* were to reduce fatigue of the fingers and joints, relieving the wrists, speeding up the process of entering text after the user acquired non-sighted writing skills, and – which is the least important – easier access to letters of the Polish alphabet.



klawaqvx.zip MD5: 1fb4bc630132bf5739582d83aeca2459

Click the image to download an installer of this keyboard layout for Microsoft Windows. The installation will start after unpacking the downloaded file and running *setup.exe* with administrator privileges – the process itself is intuitive. These layouts are uninstalled after restarting the program and selecting *Remove [...]* option, while to switch them, press the Ctrl + Shift key combination. In the downloaded archive there is also a source file with *KLC* extension, that is made in Microsoft Keyboard Layout Creator 1.4.

5. An example

So far, I have shown individual words and phrases. The time has come to present words of the Polish National Anthem written in a new way. On the right, I put the same text as on the left, but I replaced *h, q, v, x* within digraphs with spaces to make reading easier. Although every mature citizen shall know *Mazurek Dąbrowski* by heart, one may encounter difficulties in reading Polish written differently than has learned.

Altered spelling	Contemporary A.	Without digraphs
Jesqcqe Polska nxe zginevlva, Kxedy my zqyjemy. Co nam obca prqemoc wzxevlva, Sqablov odbxerqemy.	Jeszcze Polska nie zginęła, Kiedy my żyjemy. Co nam obca przemoc wzięła, Szablą odbierzemy.	Jes c e Polska n e zgine l a, K edy my z yjemy. Co nam obca pr emoc wz e l a, S ablo odb er emy.
Marsq, marsq, Dovbrowski, Z zxemi wlvoskxej do Polski. Za twoim prqewodem Zlvovcqym sxev z narodem.	Marsz, marsz, Dąbrowski, Z ziemi włoskiej do Polski. Za twoim przewodem Złączym się z narodem.	Mars , mars , Do browski, Z z emi wl osk ej do Polski. Za twoim pr ewodem Zl o c ym s e z narodem.
Prqejdxem Wislvev, prqejdxem Wartev, Bevdxem Polakami. Dalv nam prqyklvad Bonaparte, Jak zwycxevzqacx mamy.	Przejdziem Wisłę, przejdziem Wartę, Będziem Polakami. Dał nam przykład Bonaparte, Jak zwyciężać mamy.	Pr ejd em Wisl e , pr ejd em Warte , Be d em Polakami. Dal nam pr ykl ad Bonaparte, Jak zwyc e z ac mamy.
Marsq, marsq, Dovbrowski...	Marsz, marsz, Dąbrowski...	Mars , mars , Do browski...
Jak Cqarnxecki do Poznanxa Po sqwedvkim zaborqe,	Jak Czarniecki do Poznania Po szwedzkim zaborze,	Jak C arn ecki do Poznan a Po s wed kim zabor e,

Dla ojcqyzny ratowanxa Wroqcxim sxev prqez morqe.	Dla ojczyzny ratowania Wrócim się przez morze.	Dla ojc yzny ratowan a Wro c im s e pr ez mor e.
Marsq, marsq, Dovbrowski...	Marsz, marsz, Dąbrowski...	Mars , mars , Do browski...
Juzq tam ojcxec do swej Basxi Moqwi zaplvakany – Slvuhhaj jeno, pono nasxi Bijov w tarabany.	Już tam ojciec do swej Basi Mówi zapłakany – Słuchaj jeno, pono nasi Biją w tarabany.	Juz tam ojc ec do swej Bas i Mo wi zapl akany – Sl u haj jeno, pono nas i Bijo w tarabany.
Marsq, marsq, Dovbrowski...	Marsz, marsz, Dąbrowski...	Mars , mars , Do browski...

Click this sentence to download the junior high school-exam sheet from April 2019. The consolidation of acquired knowledge can be facilitated by completing tasks 17 and 21, firstly using the current spelling, and secondly rewriting the solution according to *QVX* principles.
Mirror: *Zeszyt_zadan_GH-PX1-192.pdf*

Good learning is supported by spelling words phone after phone, that is, pronouncing syllables containing a phone corresponding to each letter. In order to standardize this, such syllable-spelling takes place according to such *sign* → *sound* conversion:

- vowel → vowel
- hh → hehe

- single consonant → this consonant + e
- another digraph → this digraph + e
- isolate *q, v, x* → *ku, falv, iks*

Here, all letter and digraph names are finally needed. These came to life using abovementioned conversion.
Few in red are supplemental: needed only for enhanced precision i.e. in foreign speech transliteration.

	A	Be	Ce	De	E	Fe	Ge	He	I	Je	Ke	Le	Me
+q			Cqe	Dqe									
+v				Dve	Ev							Lve	
+x		Bxe	Cxe	Dxe		Fxe	Gxe	Hxe		*Jxe*	Kxe	*Lxe*	Mxe

	Ne	O	Pe	Ku	Re	Se	Te	U	Falv	We	Iks	Y	Ze
		Oq				Sqe							Zqe
		Ov						*Uve*					
	Nxe		Pxe		*Rxe*	Sxe	Txe			Wxe			Zxe

6. Development

I consider the documents preceding this one as the basis for reform of the Polish written language. Here, in turn, I made a list of optional changes, mostly cosmetic.

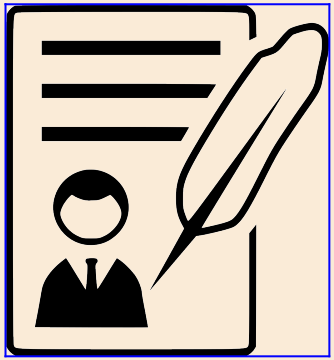
1. No obligation to write...
    - uppercase letters. They will be available for non-language applications.
    - a dot . over letters *I i*, *J j* in handwritten form. In print and display they do not change due to their everlasting form in the basic Latin alphabet.
    - any character at the end of a bullet and table items.
    - any dots . or similar signs in a quick handwritten abbreviation. However, an underscore _ is a more comfortable choice instead of a dot.

-

2. An obligation to write...
    - a dot after each letter of the acronym when readability is a priority.
    - particles *nie, by* combined with words within all parts of speech, but all other particles – separately.
    - punctuation marks inside quotation marks when using quotation marks.
    - the unit of measurement without a space after the numerical value.
    - a dot . or underscore _ after the ordinal value.
    - repeat a character at the beginning of the next line when breaking words and phrases to a new line.
    - uppercase letters in abbreviations when uppercase letters are used.
3. It is forbidden to write...
    - lowercase letters and uppercase letters mixed inside abbreviations. They shall consist exclusively of lowercase letters or only uppercase letters.
    - endings of ordinal numbers after the numerical value.

7. Author

Portfolio



facebook.com/ ortografiaqvx

krystian3slawinski@gmail.com

▲

Shure SE112-BT1 earphone diagnosis. Research on button accordion simulation. Curriculum Vitae (PL, EN).

1. Who are you?

My name is Krystian Sebastian Sławiński (krystjan sebastjan slvawinxski).

I graduated from electronic technical school at the Zespół Szkół nr 9 im. Romualda Traugutta w Koszalinie. I passed examinations confirming qualifications in the profession of an electronics technician, E.06 with 88% and 97%, E.20 with 93% and 100% (theoretical and practical parts, respectively). I have been learning English for 16 years and German for 7 years. Spelling is my strong point since elementary school, which I proved, for example on the 23rd of June 2017 by taking first place in the school's Dictation competition for the *School's Golden Pen*.

2. How did you prepare for such a manifesto?

On the 4th of November, 2017 I started translating from English to Polish on the *Falstad.com/circuit/polish* website, which has a program simulating electronic circuits. I was motivated by gratitude to author of the program resulting from my

successes in learning electronics, as well as the fact that for over four years Polish users have been holding the second place in terms of the number of page views. While updating the translation – citing the preface – 'I encountered problems related to displaying Polish letters: when the source code of a website does not indicate a code page, an Internet browser replaces these letters with incorrect characters or removes them from the text.'

3. Did you seek support?

On the 5th of April, 2018 I sent a letter with *The proposed changes in contemporary Polish spelling* to the Minister of National Education Anna Zalewska. My personal willingness to teach and the Ministry's lack of response have prompted me to act independently in this matter.

4. How to introduce the changes?

Currently, I suggest that my proposal of changes in spelling should come into force immediately, after all, the writing system is not going to change. Graduation maybe allows to extract all their benefits. According to Irena Sławińska, my grandmother born in 1937, people in post-working age are able to learn new spelling rules.

5. What shall not change that much in the language?

Throughout her life, Irena has learned to recite and sing countless Polish and many Russian lyrical works, so simplifying spelling will not ruin this ability - excellent recitation and singing are independent of the writing. The new rules are designed to facilitate learning in various fields and improve the quality of communication of Poles in their native language. My peers' lack of care for

linguistic correctness is partly due to the imperfection of technology, and this reform gives a chance to correct it.

Below are links to websites of people from whom I am drawing knowledge, values or goals:

`

1. Matlaw, 2. Piteusz,
3. G. Jagodziński, 4. prof. B. Rocławski, 5. Qrczak, 6. P. Falstad, 7. dr P. Stankiewicz,
8. prof. R. Wilkiewicz